

Audition ni Atasha, may resibo! P.3

Mbappe, Dembele fire France past Morocco into World Cup semifinals P.4

DOST XII AND DOST-ITDI PARTNERSHIP FOR SOCCSKARGEN’S EXPANDED REGIONAL METROLOGY LABORATORY

BY: DOST

A significant milestone toward strengthening the region’s quality infrastructure has been achieved as the Department of Science and Technology (DOST) Region XII formally entered into a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) with the DOST-Industrial Technology Development Institute (DOST-ITDI) on July 2, 2026, paving the way for the expansion of the SOCCSKSARGEN Regional Metrology Laboratory. Spearheaded through the foresight and steadfast leadership of Regional Director Engr. Sammy P. Malawan, PhD, the partnership marks a bold

step in realizing a larger, more advanced metrology facility that will deliver wider calibration and measurement services to industries, institutions, government agencies, and emerging enterprises across the region. The ceremonial signing, led by DOST-ITDI Director Dr. Annabelle V. Briones together with officials from DOST XII and the DOST-ITDI National Metrology Division (NMD), reflected a shared commitment to bringing nationally recognized metrology services closer to the countryside. More than a ceremonial agreement, the MOU em-

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OCD-X Kicks Off National Disaster Resilience Month 2026 with Regionwide DRRM Caravan



CAGAYAN DE ORO CITY — The Office of Civil Defense Regional Office X (OCD-X), in partnership with SM CDO Downtown, offi-

cially launched the observance of National Disaster Resilience Month (NDRM) 2026 on July 1 through a Disaster Risk Reduction and Manage-

ment (DRRM) Caravan and Static Display, highlighting the region's commitment to building safer and more disaster-resilient communities.

The event, which served as the official regional kick-off, gathered members of the Regional Disaster Risk Reduction

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SUSTAINING CLEAN WATERWAYS



Bulacan Gov. Daniel R. Fernando, together with Vice Gov. Alexis C. Castro and Bulacan Environment and Natural Resources Office (BENRO) Department Head Atty. Julius Victor C. Degala, presents during the first Monday Flag Raising

Ceremony at the Bulacan Capitol Gymnasium, City of Malolos, Bulacan, the Certificate of Recognition awarded by the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR) for participating in the implementation

➔ (TURN TO PAGE 2)

SUSTAINING CLEAN...

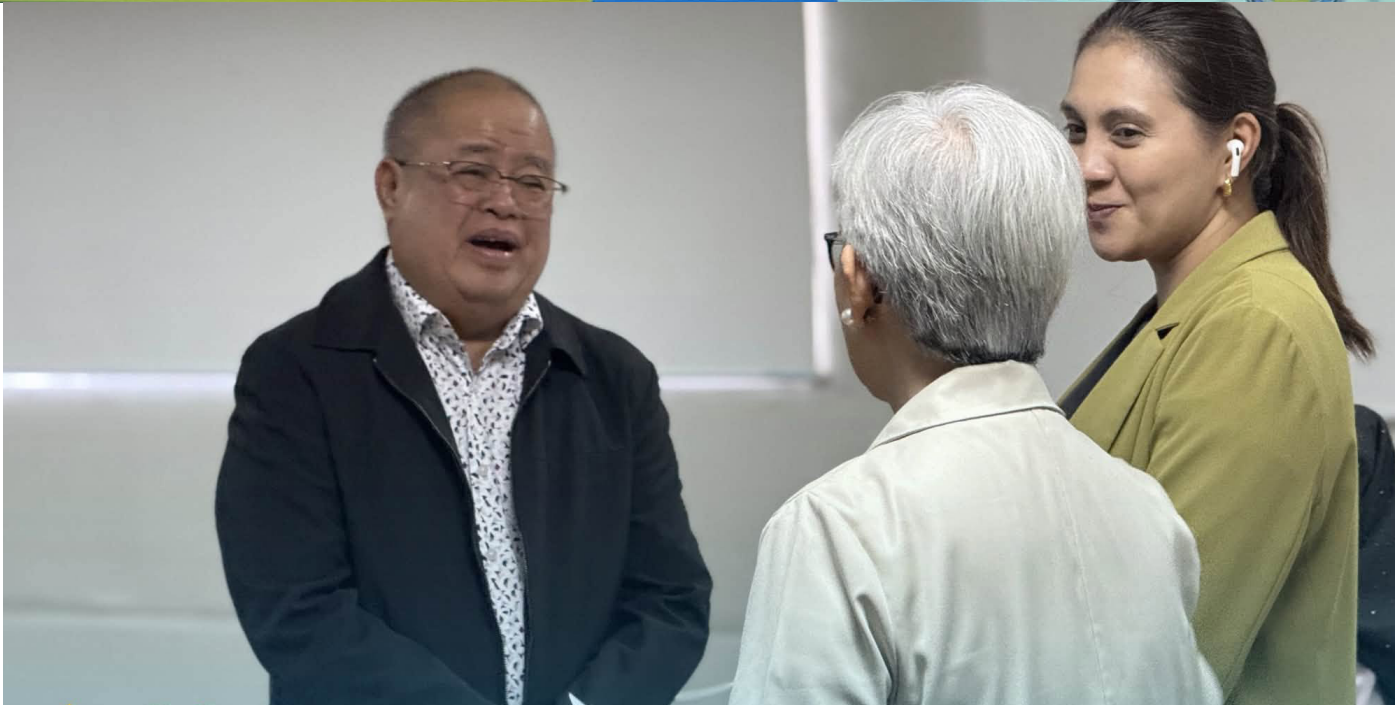
From page 1

of the Adopt an Estero/ Waterbody Program last June 10, 2026 at the Widus Hotel Clark, Clark Freeport Zone, Pampanga. Also in the photo are (from left) Board Members Josef Andrew T. Mendoza, Michael M. Aquino, Liberato P. Sembrano, Richard A. Roque, Erlene Luz V. Dela Cruz, Romina D. Fermin, Provincial Administrator Antonia V. Constantino, Philippine Amusement and Gaming Corporation Chairman Alejandro H. Tengco, BENRO Waste Management and Pollution Control Division Chief Arminda D. Carreon, Board Members Romeo V. Castro, Jr., Fortunato SJ. Angeles, Raul A. Mariano, Casey Tyronne E. Howard, and Anna Kathrina M. Hernandez. Ipinapakita nina Gob. Daniel R. Fernando, kasama sina Bise Gob. Alexis C. Castro at Puno ng Bulacan Environment and Natural Resources Office (BENRO) Abgd. Julius Victor C. Degala, sa Unang Lunes na Seremonya ng Pagtata-

as ng Watawat sa Bulacan Capitol Gymnasium, Lungsod ng Malolos, Bulacan, ang Sertipiko ng Pagkilala na iginawad ng Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR) dahil sa pakikibahagi sa pagpapatupad ng Adopt an Estero/Waterbody Program noong Hunyo 10, 2026 sa Widus Hotel Clark, Clark Freeport Zone, Pampanga. Kasama rin sa larawan sina (mula sa kaliwa) nina mga Bokal Josef Andrew T. Mendoza, Michael M. Aquino, Liberato P. Sembrano, Richard A. Roque, Erlene Luz V. Dela Cruz, Romina D. Fermin, Panlalawigang Tagapangasiwa Antonia V. Constantino, Philippine Amusement and Gaming Corporation Chairman Alejandro H. Tengco, BENRO Waste Management and Pollution Control Division Chief Arminda D. Carreon, mga Bokal Romeo V. Castro, Jr., Fortunato SJ. Angeles, Raul A. Mariano, Casey Tyronne E. Howard, at Anna Kathrina M. Hernandez.

DOST XII AND DOST-ITDI PARTNERSHIP
FOR SOCCSKARGEN'S EXPANDED...

From page 1



bodies a common vision of empowering regional development through precision, traceability, and measurement excellence – strengthening the foundations of manufacturing, agriculture, healthcare, research, trade, and innovation in SOCCSKSARGEN. Once established in Polomolok, South Cotabato, the expanded Regional Metrology Laboratory is envisioned to become a strategic hub that will significantly improve the accessibility of calibration services in the region.

By reducing the need for stakeholders to seek metrology services outside SOCCSKSARGEN, the facility is expected to enhance operational efficiency, support regulatory compliance, improve product quality, and increase the competitiveness of local industries. It likewise reinforces DOST's commitment to building a robust regional quality infrastructure that supports science-driven economic growth and prepares local enterprises to meet both national and international standards.

In his message, RD Malawan underscored the transformative impact of the initiative, emphasizing that the laboratory represents an investment in the region's future. "We see this laboratory as a valuable resource that will serve not only today's industries but also future innovators, researchers, and entrepreneurs across the region. We are grateful to be part of this undertaking, and we look forward to building a stronger culture of quality and excellence that will contribute to the

continued growth and development of SOCCSKSARGEN," he said. With DOST XII, DOST-ITDI, and the National Metrology Division working hand in hand, the initiative reinforces the Department's commitment to making world-class measurement science more accessible to the regions – ensuring that precision, quality, and innovation remain at the heart of SOCCSKSARGEN's journey toward inclusive and sustainable development.

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Cavite
Wisdom
Publishing
Kaalaman at Katotohanan para sa Bayan

CAVITE WISDOM PUBLISHING IS
PUBLISHED WEEKLY EVERY MONDAY

OFFICE ADDRESS:
B18 L14 Ph10 Oxygen St. Dasma 4 Golden City Barangay Salawag,
Dasmariñas City, Cavite 4114 Philippines Cel # 09176275522
Email Ad: wisdom.cavite@gmail.com
Fb Page: Wisdom Newspaper
Website: cavitewisdom.com

Krishan Joy C. Lacza
PUBLISHER

Jet Claveria
EDITOR IN CHIEF

Minnie Clet
MANAGING EDITOR

Charlene Edora
DESK EDITOR

Martin Banaag / Tantan Francisco
REPORTER

Darell Tropicales
CIRCULATION MANAGER

Eagle Jaime
GRAPHIC DESIGNER

Atty. Evelyn Dominguez / Atty. Eloisa Papa
LEGAL ADVISER

Papi
REBECCA M. VELASQUEZ
President

Nothing is
impossible. The
word itself says
'I'm possible!'

AUDREY HEPBURN

REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES
FOURTH JUDICIAL REGION
REGIONAL TRIAL COURT
BRANCH 129
DASMARIÑAS CITY, CAVITE
rtcdas129@judiciary.gov.ph/0956-405-7604

IN RE: PETITION FOR CORRECTION OF
ENRTY IN THE CERTIFICATE OF LIVE
BIRTH OF JOHNSON TOLENTINO FABRO,

JOHNSON TOLENTINO FABRO,

-versus-

THE LOCAL CIVIL REGISTRAR OF
DASMARIÑAS CAVITE AND THE
PHILIPPINE STATISTICS OFFICE,

X-----X

SECOND (2ND) ORDER

Before this Court is a verified Petition for correction of entry filed by Petitioner
JOHNSON TOLENTINO FABRO through counsel, praying that after due notice and hearing,
judgment be rendered directing the Local Civil Registrar of Dasmariñas City, Cavite to correct
the entry number 3 (Date of Birth) of Certificate of Live Birth of JOHNSON TOLENTINO
FABRO, under Local Civil Registry No. 2008-07671 from March 17, 2008 to March 17, 2004

Finding the instant petition to be sufficient in form and substance, this
Court hereby sets the hearing thereof at the Regional Trial Court Branch 129, Dasmariñas
City, Cavite on August 4, 2026 at 9:00 o'clock in the morning whereby any interest-
ed persons may appear and show cause if any why the petition should not be granted.

Let this Order be published, at the expense of the petitioner in a newspaper of
General Circulation in the Province of Cavite, which will be raffled by the Office of the Clerk
of Court Regional Trial Court, Dasmariñas City, Cavite, among the duly accredited newspa-
per, before the scheduled date of hearing, at least once a week for three (3) consecutive weeks.

SO ORDERED.

GIVEN IN OPEN COURT, this 7th day of
April 2026 at Dasmariñas City, Cavite.

JOSIELYN D. LARA- DE LUNA (signed)
Executive Judge

Cc:
Office of the Solicitor General
134 Amorsolo St., Legaspi Village Makati City, 1229

Pros. Frela S. Pancho-Dela Cruz
Pros. Carlo Edison Aba
OCP-Dasmariñas City, Cavite 4114

Atty. Jennifer Delos Reyes
PAO-Dasmariñas City, Cavite

Johnson Tolentino Fabro
Blk. C-10, Lot 3, Brgy. San Simon,
Dasmariñas City, Cavite
The City Civil Registrar
City Hall, Dasmariñas City, Cavite

Civil Registrar General/Administrator
Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA), Quezon Ave.,
Quezon City

The Clerk of Court
OCC-RTC Dasmariñas City, Cavite

Wisdom
July 13, 20 & 27, 2026

OCD-X Kicks Off National Disaster Resilience Month 2026... From page 1



and Management Council (RDRRMC)-X, local government units, development partners, uniformed services, civil society organizations, schools, volunteers, media representatives, and the public in a unified effort to promote disaster preparedness and resilience. Representatives of the four thematic pillars of disaster risk reduction and management—Disaster Prevention and Mitigation, Disaster Preparedness, Disaster Response and Early Recovery, and Disaster Rehabilitation and Recovery—joined the opening ceremony, along with officials from various national government agencies and partner organizations. In his keynote address, OCD-X Regional Director and RDRRMC-X Chairperson Antonio B. Sugarol underscored the significance of this year's theme, "Naghahanda at Kumikilos Tungo sa Panatag na Bagong Pilipinas." He said disaster resilience begins with sustained preparedness, active community participation, and strong partnerships among government agencies, local governments, the private sector, and the public. He urged every Filipino to make preparedness a daily habit rather than an annual activity. One of the event's highlights was the DRRM Caravan and Static Display, where participating agencies showcased disaster preparedness programs, emergency response equipment, rescue capabilities, and public safety initiatives. Among the participating agencies were DSWD Field Office X, DOST-PHIVOLCS, PAGASA, the Philippine

Coast Guard, Philippine National Police, Philippine Army, Bureau of Fire Protection, Philippine Red Cross, DICT, and other RDRRMC-X member agencies. Local disaster risk reduction and management offices from Cagayan de Oro City, Iligan City, Misamis Oriental, and Camiguin also presented their disaster management programs, emphasizing the critical role of local governments in strengthening community resilience. Visitors, including students, families, and disaster risk reduction advocates, toured the exhibits, viewed emergency response vehicles and equipment, and participated in information sessions and demonstrations designed to improve public awareness and preparedness. Simultaneous launch activities were likewise held in the provinces of Bukidnon, Lanao del Norte, and Misamis Occidental, demonstrating Northern Mindanao's unified commitment to advancing disaster resilience across the region. Director Sugarol expressed his gratitude to all participating agencies, local government units, partner organizations, volunteers, schools, civil society groups, media partners, and SM CDO Downtown for helping make the regional launch a success. He noted that the kick-off marks the beginning of a month-long series of activities aimed at promoting disaster prevention, preparedness, response, recovery, and rehabilitation, while reinforcing the message that disaster resilience is a shared responsibility and a way of life.

SHOWBLITZ

By: Charlene Mae

Audition ni Atasha, may resibo!

PETA nagsalita Grabe ang mga bash- er. Ayaw tigilan si Atasha Muhlach. Ang daming hanash na dinan daw sa palakasan kaya naibigay kay Atasha ang role na Annie Batungbakal sa Bongga Ka ‘Day: The Musical na mapapanood sa Newport Performing Arts Theater starting September. Kesyo kawa- wa naman daw ang ibang mga pumila. Actually parang scripted ang mga bashing kay Atasha. May pattern kasi ang mga sinasabi nila. Pero may resibo ang audition ni Atasha. Kasama niya pa ang lola Elvie Gonzales niya sa nasabing audition kaya ‘wag gawan ng intriga. Si Elvie Gonzales ang nan- ay ng mommy ni Atasha na si Charlene Gonzales. Saka nagsalita na si Melvin Lee, PETA President and PETA Plus Program Director, para patotohanan ito. “Atasha delivered a strong audition, showcasing solid singing, dancing, and stage presence,” umpisa ni Melvin sa kanyang statement. Dagdag niya pa: “She displayed natural chemistry with the male actors and blended seamlessly with the ensemble of triple-threat theater performers. More important- ly, she brought the charis- ma, warmth, and panache needed for Annie Batung- bakal, with the charm and look to convincingly lead the production.” At idiniin niya na pinatunayan ni Atasha na siya ang karapat-dapat na gumana sa nasabing character. “Overall, she proved to be a strong choice for the role.” Nagpasampol na si Atasha bilang bida sa Bongga Ka, ‘Day: The Annie Batungbakal Musical.

sical noong isang araw sa ginanap na media launch- ing nito three days ago. Follow-up project ito ng Newport World Re- sorts, VIVA Communica- tions and The Philippine STAR sa matagumpay na Bagets The Musical. At kasama ni Atasha na bibida rito sina Sam Concepcion, KD Estrada, Jeff Moses and Anthony Rosaldo. Mahigit 300 auditionees ang naka- sabay ni Atasha ayon mismo sa taga-PETA. At naging motiva- tion ng isa sa kambal nina Aga Muhlach at Charlene ay nung napanood niya ang Bagets The Musical na ang isa sa mga bida ang kakambal niyang si Andres. “I started texting all my dance workshops, acting coaches, and sing- ing coaches the moment I heard auditions were open,” sabi pa ni Atasha sa naunang interview namin. Alam daw niyang hindi ‘yun madali. “It motivates me because it’s so nice to see my brother, of course, performing on the stage and seeing him do something that he’s never done before, stepping out of his comfort zone. And as a sister, that’s such a proud moment kasi nakita ko lahat ng mga hard work na ginawa ng buong cast ng Bagets.” Pero ano nga ba ang nakita nila kay Ata- sha para gumana sa An- nie Batungbakal? “Yung charm, ‘yung cuteness ng Annie character, she has it. Nung nakita namin siya, hindi na kami na- hirapan piliin agad siya. Nag-stand out talaga siya, si Atasha, from the whole crowd,” paliwan- ag pa ng PETA represen- tative na nagpa-audition sa buong cast ng Bong- ga Ka, ‘Day!: The Annie Batungbakal Musical.

“Happiness is not something readymade it comes from your own actions.”

DALAI LAMA



SPORTS NEWS

Mbappe, Dembele fire France past Morocco into



LOS ANGELES, United States — France underscored its status as the World Cup's team to beat on Thursday (Friday Manila time), overpowering African champions Morocco with a clinical 2-0 win to book its third consecutive semifinals appearance.

Kylian Mbappe curled in his eighth goal of the tournament on 60 minutes before Ousmane Dembele doubled Les Bleus' lead six minutes later to complete a drama-free victory at the Gillette Stadium outside Boston.

The win sends the 2018 champion into the Last Four, where it will face either Spain or Belgium at the Dallas Cowboys' AT&T Stadium in Arlington, Texas next Tuesday.

"I think that is three consecutive semifinals, so that's already a good thing. It seems logical and natural, but you still have to achieve it," France coach Didier Deschamps said.

"Obviously, I have great players, otherwise we wouldn't get there, but it's good."

Morocco had been tipped to pose a serious threat to France's hopes of reaching a third consecutive World Cup final.

But Deschamps' men were always in control against toothless opponents, who failed to register a single shot on goal until the 83rd minute, when Azzedine Ounahi's long-range strike was parried away by France goalkeeper Mike Maignan.

France struggled to find an early breakthrough, and missed the opportunity to take the lead on 28 minutes when Mbappe had a penalty saved by Morocco goalkeeper Yassine Bounou.

Mbappe had won the spot-kick after being brought down by Noussair Mazraoui but was forced to wait several minutes before being allowed to take the penalty after a protracted VAR check.

Morocco managed to hold out to halftime but it was always only a matter of time before France's relentless pressure paid off.

The breakthrough came on the hour mark, with Mbappe bending a brilliant right-foot shot past Bounou from the edge of the area.

Paris Saint-Germain star Dembele made the game safe in the 66th minute, striding forward menacingly from midfield before steering a low finish into the bottom corner.

Mbappe, who was substituted and received treatment for a minor ankle knock, later played down France's favorites tag, insisting the team's bid to win a third World Cup was far from complete.

"We are in the semifinals and we are very pleased. There is still a long way to go and we are aware that what awaits is going to be even harder, but we are ready," Mbappe said.

Referee chief hits back Spain, which has not conceded a single goal so far, eliminated Cristiano Ronaldo's Portugal in the Last 16 and will fancy its chances of overcoming Belgium, which thrashed United States, 4-1, to reach the Last Eight.

Belgium coach Rudi Garcia sounded a defiant note on the eve of Friday's game, adamant that it was ill-advised to underestimate a Red Devils side that have gradually built momentum.

"Everyone is already talking about us going home. But we think that we can do it," Garcia said.

"We think we can pull it off, and we're go-

ing to do everything we can to get to the semis."

On the other side of the draw, defending champion Argentina faces Switzerland in Kansas City on Saturday after staggering into the quarterfinals.

The South Americans, aiming to become the first back-to-back champions since Brazil in 1962, advanced to the quarterfinals after an incredible escape against Egypt in the previous round, recovering from a 2-0 deficit to win, 3-2.

The victory saw a string of refereeing decisions go in Argentina's favor, prompting claims from Egypt coach Hossam Hassan that World Cup referees were unfairly favoring the South Americans due to "external" pressure.

Those claims were shot down by FIFA referees chief Pierluigi Collina on Thursday.

"Nobody can question the integrity of the FIFA World Cup match officials," Collina said.

"Nobody can claim that FIFA Refereeing can be influenced by anyone."

The winner of the Argentina-Switzerland clash will take on either Norway or England, which clash in Miami on Saturday.

England's defense faces the unenviable task of having to contain Norway's irrepressible striker Erling Haaland, who has been in blistering form on his team's run to the last eight.

A relaxed Haaland said Thursday the pressure would be on England when the teams meet at the Hard Rock Stadium.

"I think there's some clear favorites out there, England's one of them," Haaland told reporters.

"I think all of you





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